



From Data to Solutions · Weekend 0

scikit-learn

one workflow, not an algorithm zoo

Carlos Cotrini



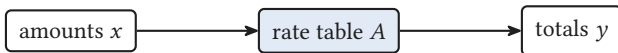
Section 1

From applying a rule to learning one



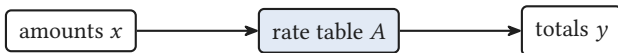
From applying a rule to learning one

This morning you were handed the rule



this morning (NumPy): $y = A x$, forward

This morning you were handed the rule

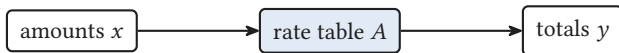


this morning (NumPy): $y = A x$, forward



the cafe lost its price list: (shots, milk, price)

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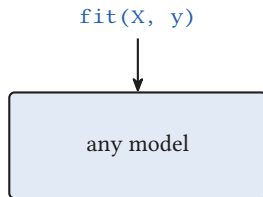


the cafe lost its price list: (shots, milk, price)

machine learning: learn the rule from examples

■ From applying a rule to learning one

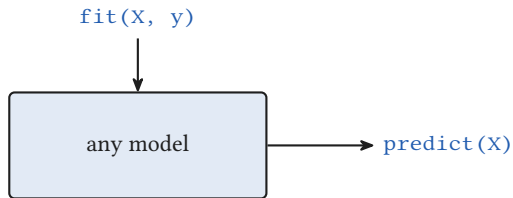
scikit-learn is one workflow



- the same three verbs for every model

From applying a rule to learning one

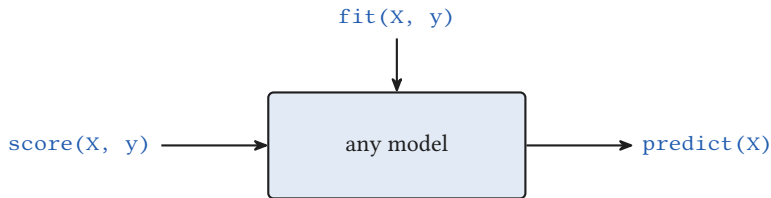
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- the **same three verbs** for every model
- today: **two** models, not twenty

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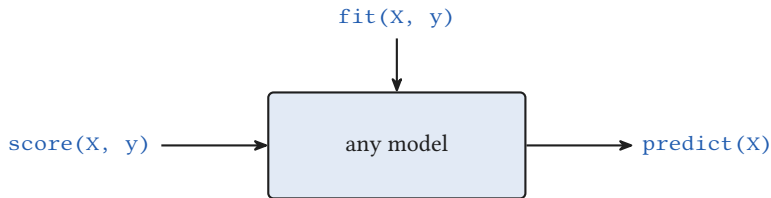
scikit-learn is one workflow



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- no algorithm zoo, no tuning marathons

From applying a rule to learning one

scikit-learn is one workflow



- the **same three verbs** for every model
- today: **two** models, not twenty
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learn the workflow, not the zoo



Section 2

The estimator API

2

You could hand-roll this fit

```
for step in range(2000):  
    yhat = w*shots + b  
    err = yhat - price  
    w = w - lr*(err*shots).mean()  
    b = b - lr*err.mean()
```

gradient descent, by hand, with the NumPy you have

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LinearRegression().fit(X, y)

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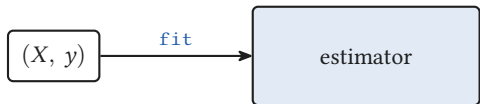
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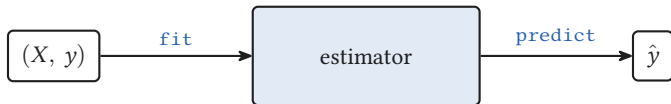
same best-fit line, one call (sklearn picks the solver)

Three verbs, one object



`fit` learn from labelled examples

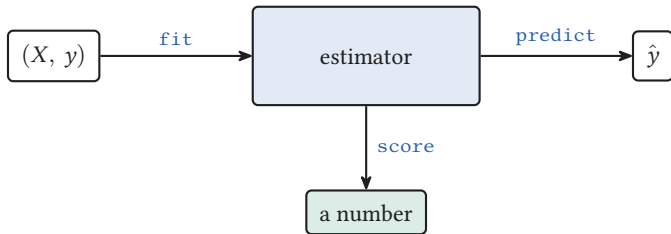
Three verbs, one object



`fit` learn from labelled examples

`predict` apply to new inputs

Three verbs, one object



`fit` learn from labelled examples

`predict` apply to new inputs

`score` grade against the truth

The machine recovers your price rule

$$\text{price} = \underbrace{2.00}_{\text{base cup}}$$

The machine recovers your price rule

$$\text{price} = 2.00 + \underbrace{0.91}_{\text{per shot}} \text{ shots}$$

The machine recovers your price rule

$$\text{price} = 2.00 + 0.91 \text{ shots} + \underbrace{0.0038}_{\text{per ml}} \text{ milk}$$

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true rule was $2.00 + 0.90 \text{ shots} + 0.004 \text{ milk}$

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- learned from **180** receipts

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- `coef_` is a **rate row**: the A from $y = A x$, now learned

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- a flat white (2, 150): **CHF 4.39**

The machine recovers your price rule

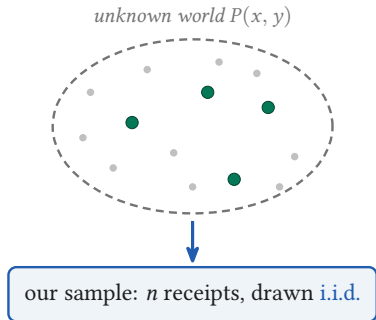
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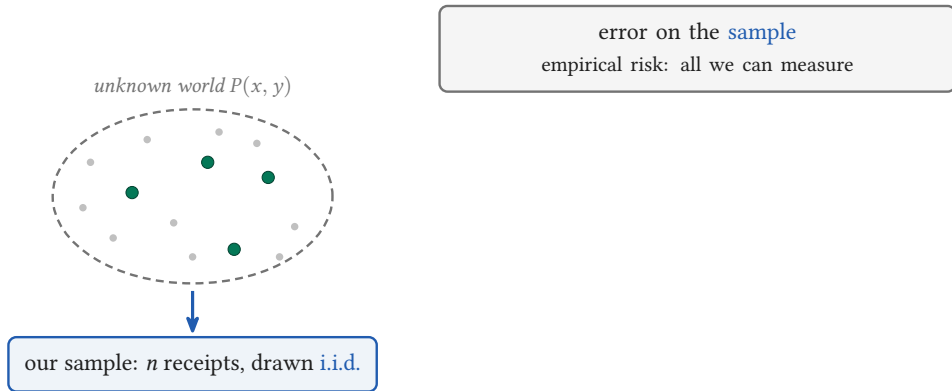
- learned from **180** receipts
- `coef_` is a **rate row**: the A from $y = A x$, now learned
- a flat white (2, 150): **CHF 4.39**

you stopped hand-writing the optimisation

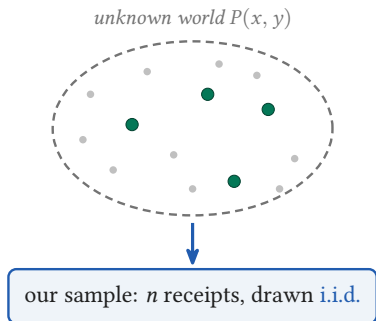
A word from learning theory



A word from learning theory



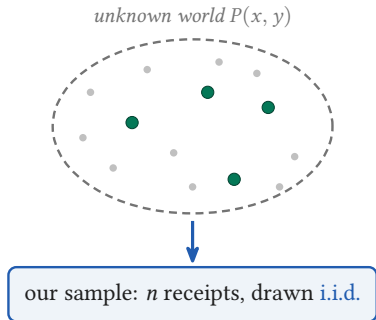
A word from learning theory



error on the **sample**
empirical risk: all we can measure

error on the **future**
true risk: what we really want

A word from learning theory

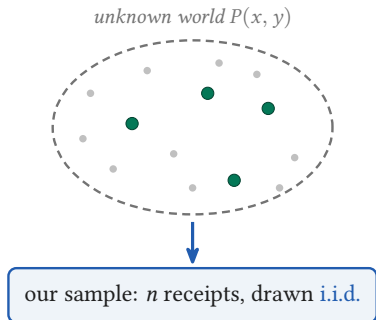


error on the **sample**
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fit: smallest sample error over a **family H**
search the candidate rules (ERM)

A word from learning theory



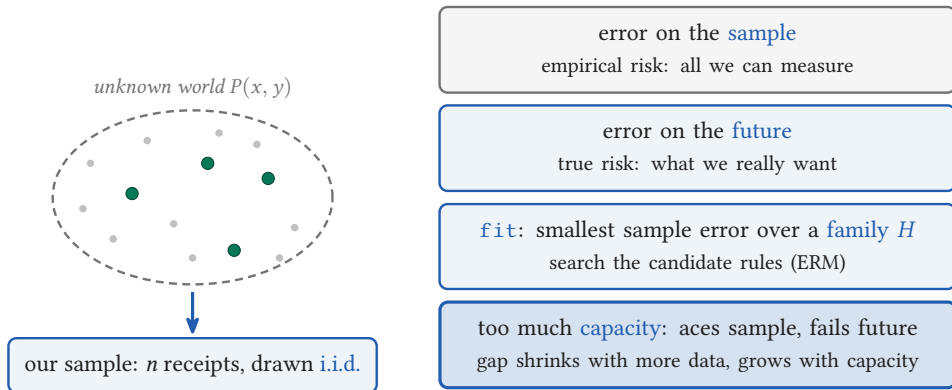
error on the **sample**
empirical risk: all we can measure

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fit: smallest sample error over a **family H**
search the candidate rules (ERM)

too much **capacity**: aces sample, fails future
gap shrinks with more data, grows with capacity

A word from learning theory



fit minimises sample error; we really want small future error

Learning theory is the three verbs

Learning theory

hypothesis class H



scikit-learn

the model, e.g. `LinearRegression()`

Learning theory is the three verbs

Learning theory

hypothesis class H

i.i.d. sample from $P(x, y)$



scikit-learn

the model, e.g. `LinearRegression()`

the data (X, y) , a row per example

Learning theory is the three verbs

Learning theory

hypothesis class H

i.i.d. sample from $P(x, y)$

minimise empirical risk (ERM)

↪

↪

↪

scikit-learn

the model, e.g. `LinearRegression()`

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`model.fit(X, y)`

Learning theory is the three verbs

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hypothesis class H

i.i.d. sample from $P(x, y)$

minimise empirical risk (ERM)

apply the rule to a new input

↦

↦

↦

↦

scikit-learn

the model, e.g. `LinearRegression()`

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`model.fit(X, y)`

`model.predict(X)`

Learning theory is the three verbs

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scikit-learn

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the model, e.g. `LinearRegression()`

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`model.fit(X, y)`

apply the rule to a new input



`model.predict(X)`

true risk: error on the future



what `score` on the `test` set estimates

Learning theory is the three verbs

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scikit-learn

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↦

the model, e.g. `LinearRegression()`

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minimise empirical risk (ERM)

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`model.fit(X, y)`

apply the rule to a new input

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`model.predict(X)`

true risk: error on the future

↦

what `score` on the `test` set estimates

capacity: how many wiggles

↦

model complexity: `degree`, `max_depth`, `C`

Learning theory is the three verbs

Learning theory

scikit-learn

hypothesis class H

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the model, e.g. `LinearRegression()`

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true risk: error on the future

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what `score` on the `test` set estimates

capacity: how many wiggles

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model complexity: `degree`, `max_depth`, `C`

`fit` minimises sample error; `score` on test estimates the future



Section 3

The cardinal rule

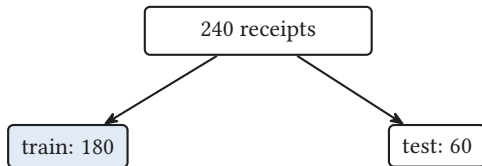
3

Never grade on what you trained on

240 receipts

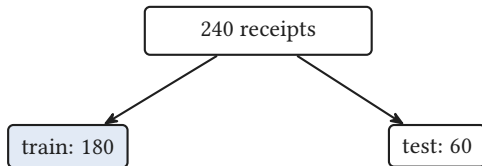
- one call: `train_test_split(X, y)`

Never grade on what you trained on



- one call: `train_test_split(X, y)`
- R^2 on train = 0.98, on test = 0.98 here

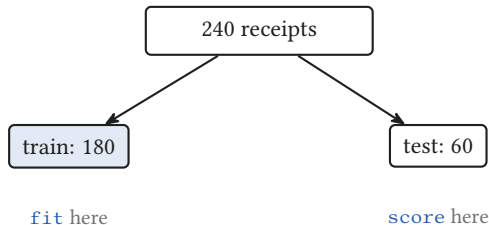
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`fit` here

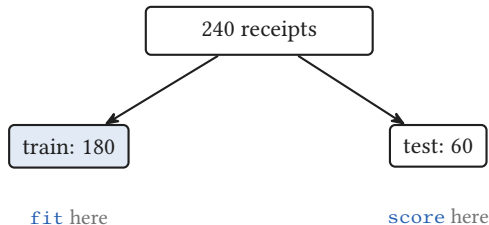
- one call: `train_test_split(X, y)`
- R^2 on train = 0.98, on test = 0.98 here
- a memoriser scores high on train, low on test

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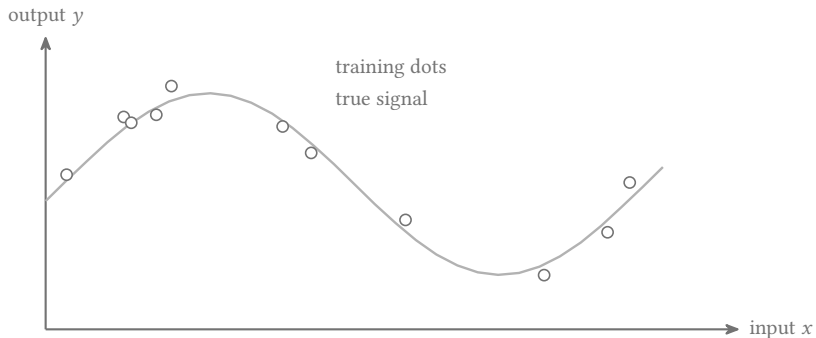
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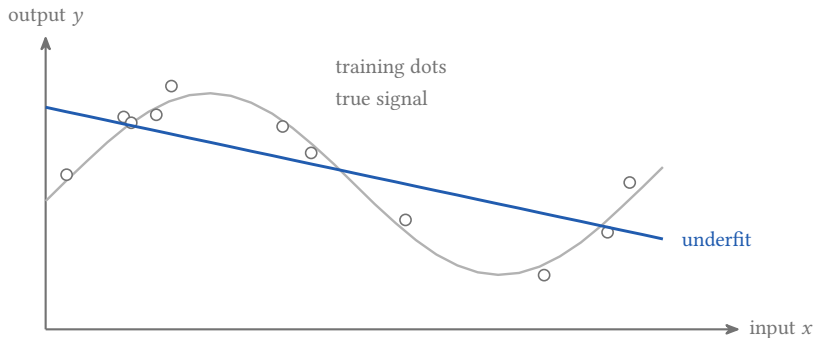
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report the score on data the model never saw

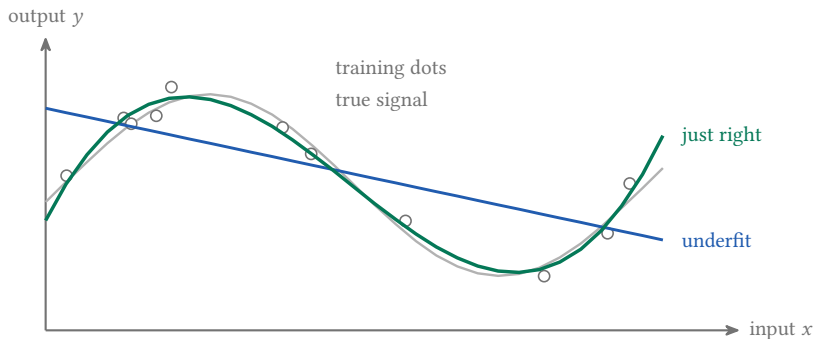
Overfitting, drawn



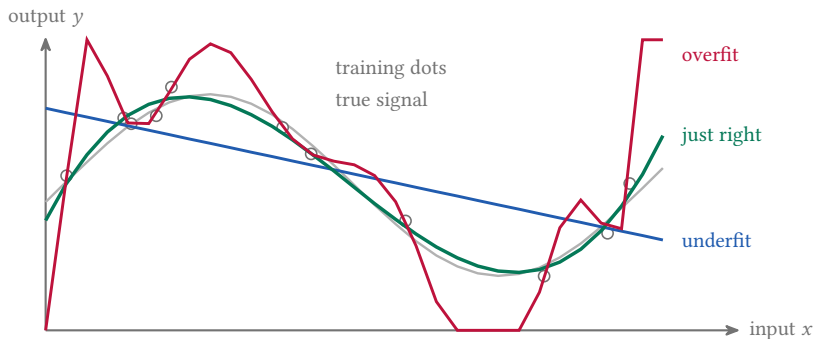
Overfitting, drawn



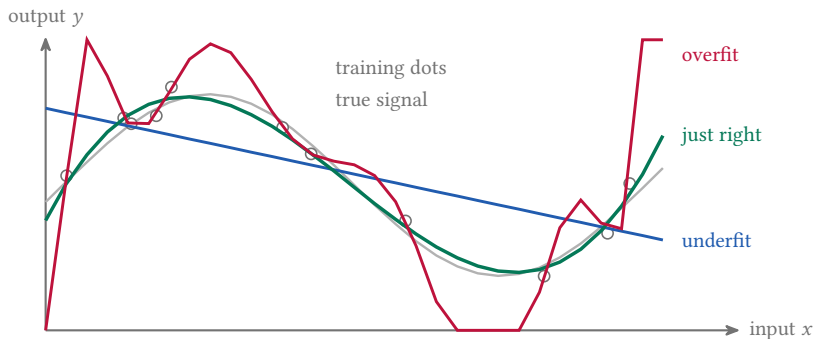
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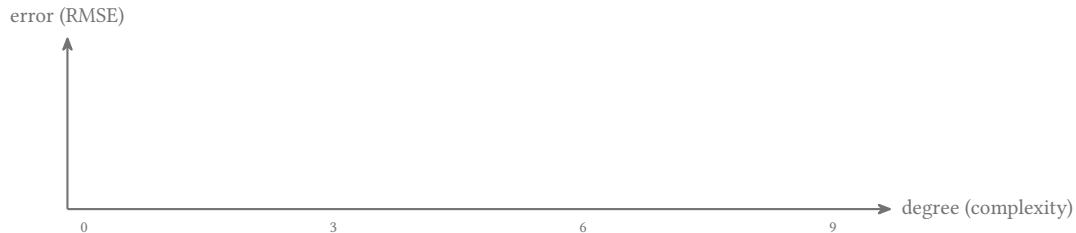


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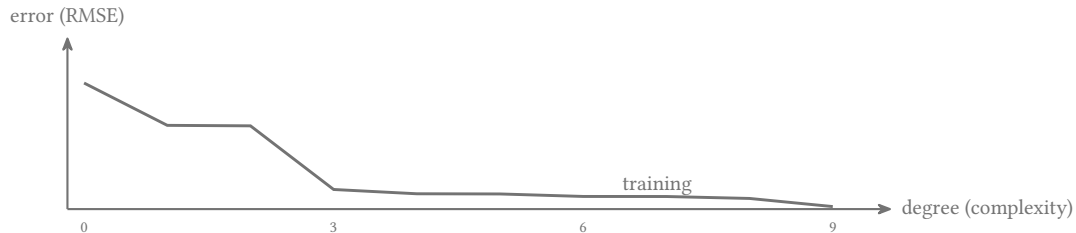


degree 9 acs the points it has seen, and fails on the next one

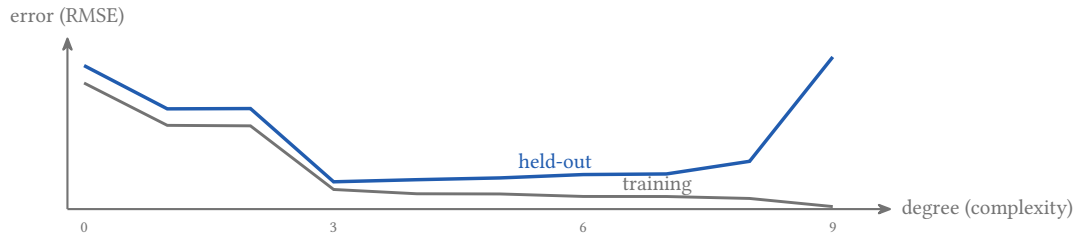
Why hold data out



Why hold data out

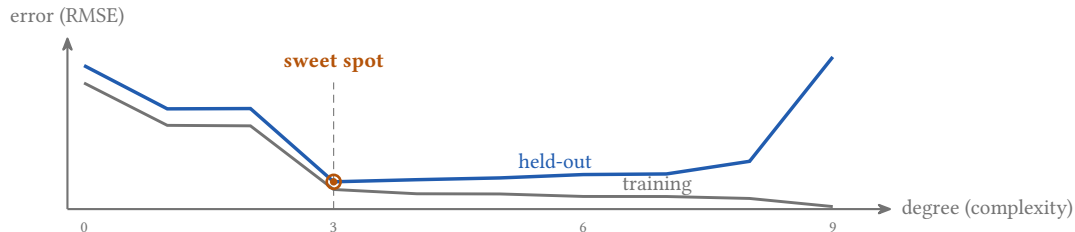


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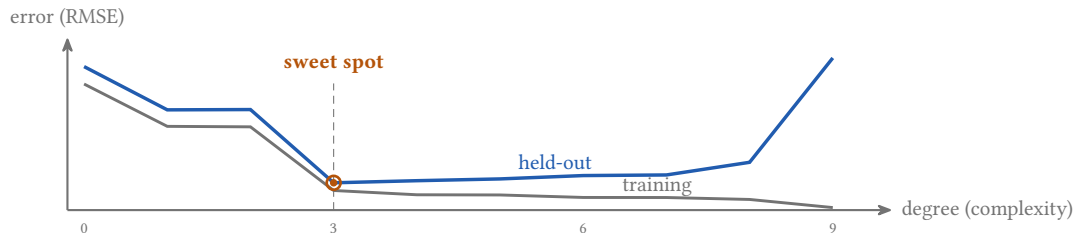


■ The cardinal rule

Why hold data out

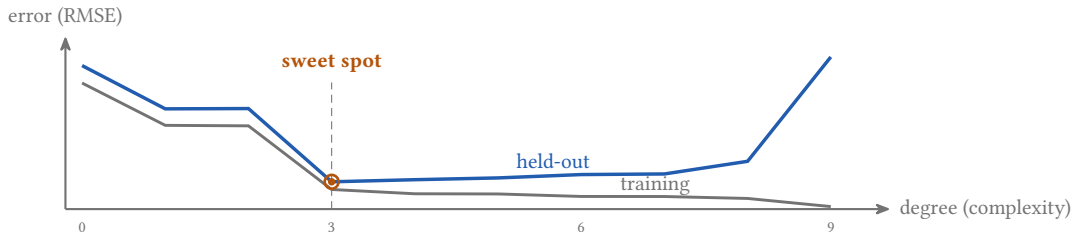


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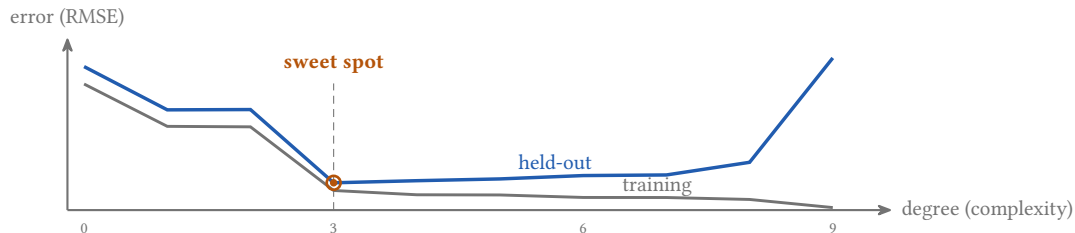
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Why hold data out



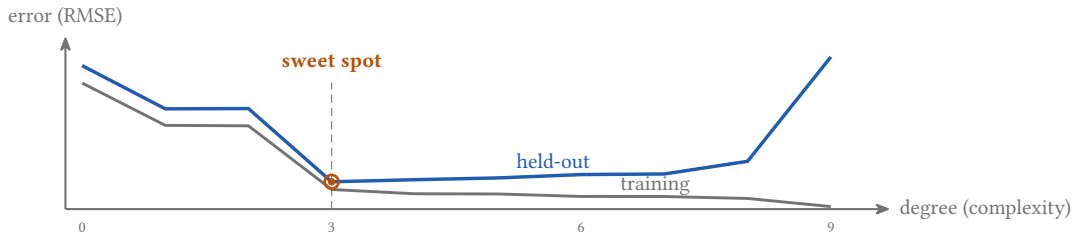
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- held-out error turns up: it can see it

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- pick the degree at the U minimum (what `cross_val_score` estimates)

Why hold data out



- training error always falls: blind to overfitting
- held-out error turns up: it can see it
- pick the degree at the U minimum (what `cross_val_score` estimates)

training error always falls; only held-out error reveals overfitting



Section 4

A number becomes a yes/no

4

■ A number becomes a yes/no

Same table, a new question

shots	milk	price	five_star
2	150	4.47	no
3	270	5.72	yes
1	0	2.88	no

- **regression:** predict a **number** (price)

■ A number becomes a yes/no

Same table, a new question

shots

milk

price

five_star

2

150

4.47

no

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270

5.72

yes

1

0

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no

- **regression:** predict a **number** (price)
- **classification:** predict a **yes/no** (a 5-star review)

■ A number becomes a yes/no

Same table, a new question

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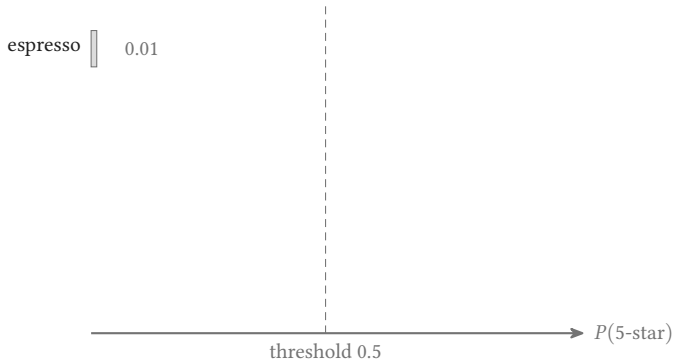
2.88

no

- **regression:** predict a **number** (price)
- **classification:** predict a **yes/no** (a 5-star review)
- `LogisticRegression().fit(X, y)`: same three verbs

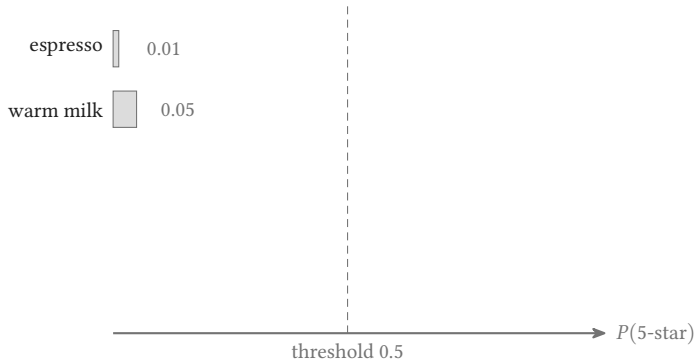
■ A number becomes a yes/no

A probability, not just a label



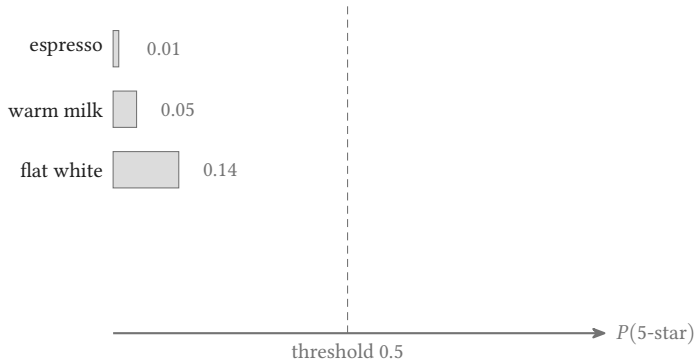
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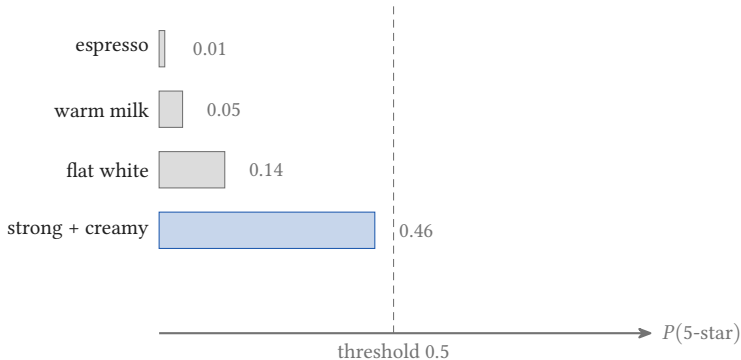
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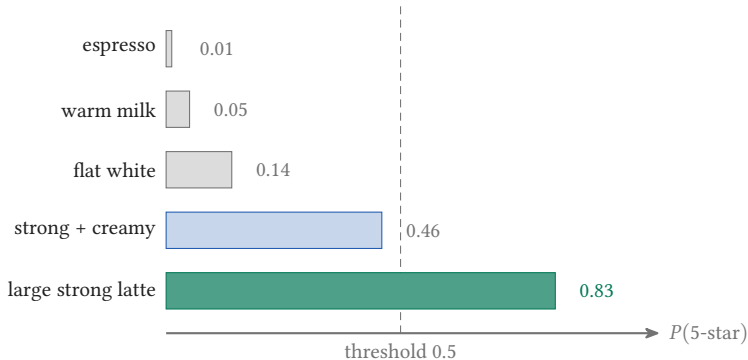
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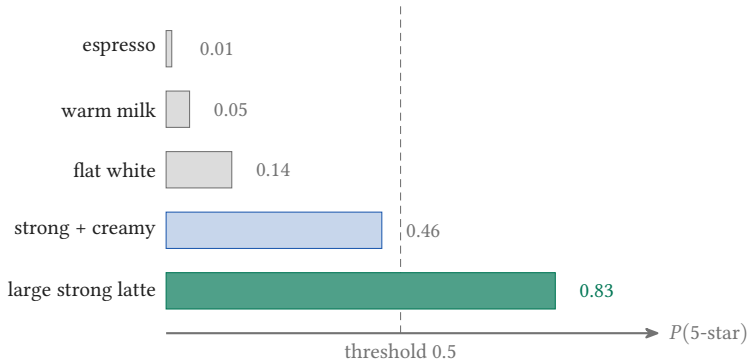
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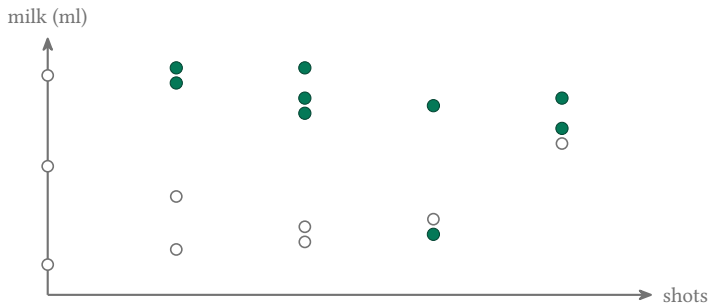
A probability, not just a label



`predict_proba` grades how sure, not just yes/no

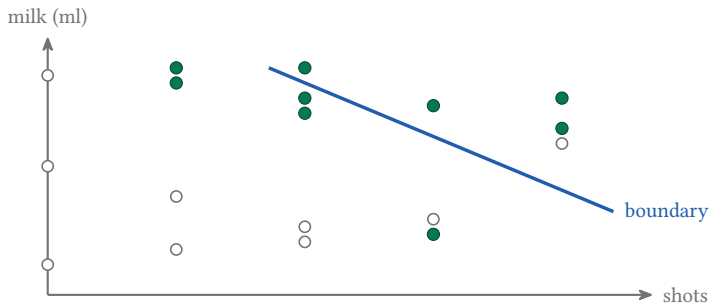
■ A number becomes a yes/no

The whole model in one picture



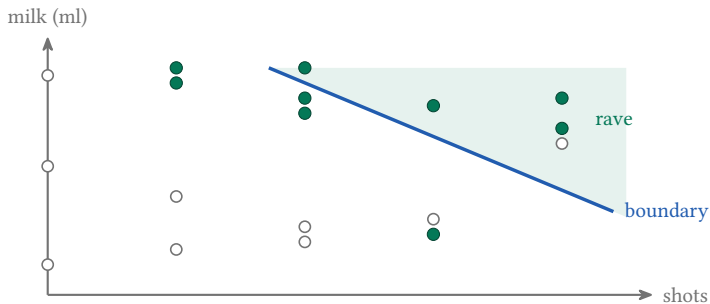
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The whole model in one picture



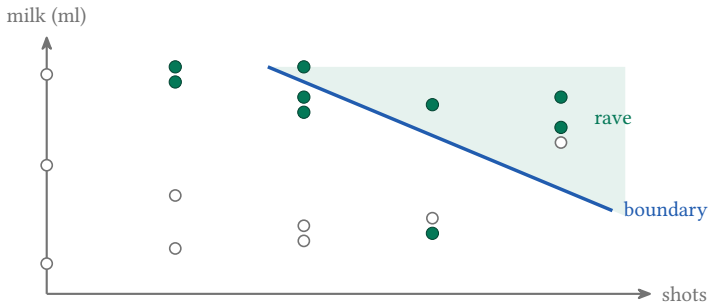
■ A number becomes a yes/no

The whole model in one picture



■ A number becomes a yes/no

The whole model in one picture



logistic regression: a line, squashed to a probability



Section 5

Accuracy can lie

5

Most drinks do not get five stars



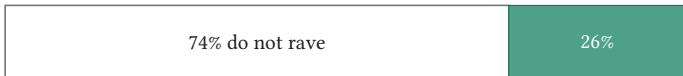
Most drinks do not get five stars



“always predict NO” is 73% accurate

and catches zero of the ravers

Most drinks do not get five stars



“always predict NO” is 73% accurate

and catches zero of the ravers

73% accurate and completely useless

Read the matrix, not the accuracy

	pred. no	pred. 5-star
actual no	40	4
actual yes	7	9

- accuracy 0.82, sounds fine

Read the matrix, not the accuracy

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- **precision** 0.69: flagged raves that were real

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Read the matrix, not the accuracy

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- **recall** 0.56: real raves it actually caught
- ROC-AUC 0.85: one honest number

Read the matrix, not the accuracy

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- accuracy 0.82, sounds fine
- **precision** 0.69: flagged raves that were real
- **recall** 0.56: real raves it actually caught
- ROC-AUC 0.85: one honest number

it misses nearly half the ravers: this is what the 2pm churn task grades

F1: one number when you need both

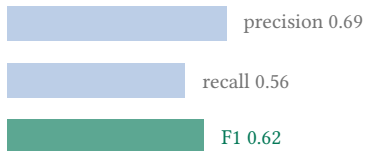
$$F_1 = \frac{2PR}{P + R}$$

F1: one number when you need both

$$F_1 = \frac{2 \times 0.69 \times 0.56}{0.69 + 0.56} = 0.62$$

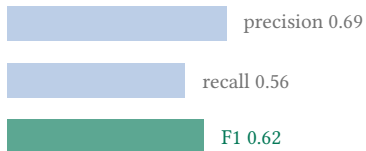
F1: one number when you need both

$$F_1 = \frac{2 \times 0.69 \times 0.56}{0.69 + 0.56} = 0.62$$



F1: one number when you need both

$$F_1 = \frac{2 \times 0.69 \times 0.56}{0.69 + 0.56} = 0.62$$



the harmonic mean: low if EITHER one is low



Section 6

Leak-proof, and any model

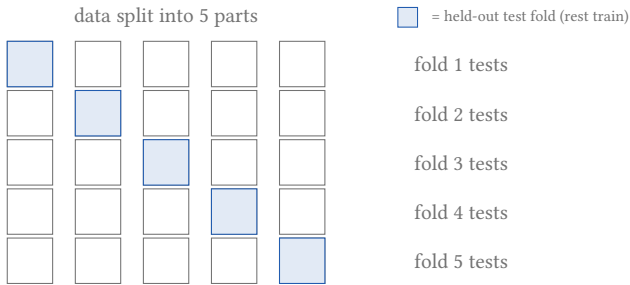
6

■ Leak-proof, and any model

Cross-validation: trust k splits, not one

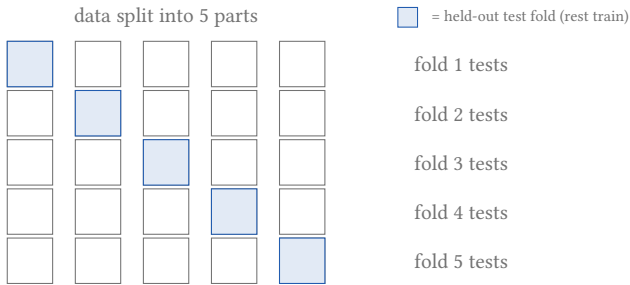
- one split scores on just 60 drinks: noisy

Cross-validation: trust k splits, not one



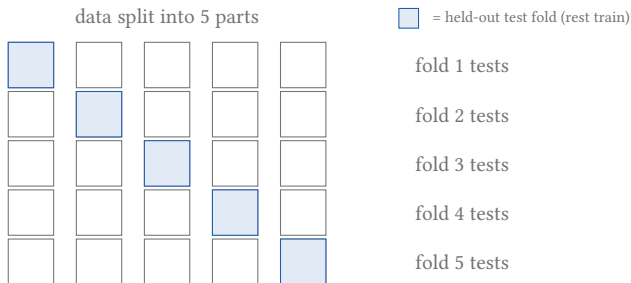
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- 5 folds: each takes a turn as the test set, the rest train

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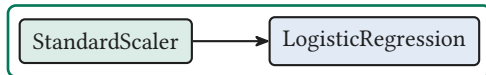
5-fold ROC-AUC 0.85 ± 0.05 , a stabler number than one split

Preprocess inside the pipeline



- scaling on the full data peeks at the test set

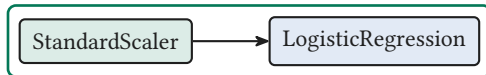
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one Pipeline, fit on the train fold only

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Preprocess inside the pipeline



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- `cross_val_score`: ROC-AUC 0.85 ± 0.05

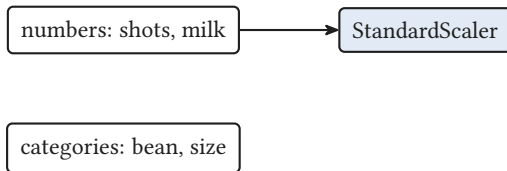
ColumnTransformer: each column type its own prep

numbers: shots, milk

categories: bean, size

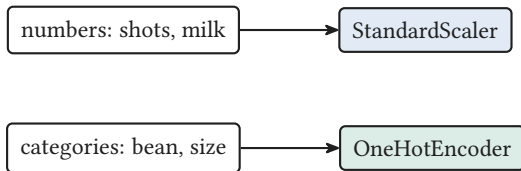
- numbers want **scaling**; categories want **one-hot**

ColumnTransformer: each column type its own prep



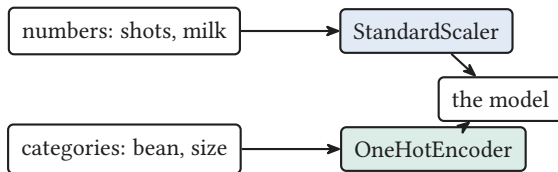
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ColumnTransformer: each column type its own prep



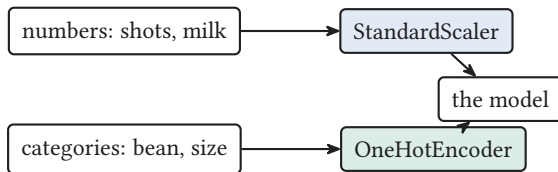
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one transform per column type, then fit as usual

Swap one word, same workflow

`LogisticRegression()` AUC 0.85



Swap one word, same workflow

`RandomForestClassifier()` AUC 0.78



Swap one word, same workflow

`RandomForestClassifier()` AUC 0.78



same `fit` · `predict` · `score` for every model (here the line wins,
do not oversell the forest)



Section 7

The workflow you keep



The card you keep

- **split first**, before you look at anything

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scikit-learn is one workflow, and you now own it